FOREIGN TRADE, WTO, FTAS AND PROTECTIONISM

TRADE TRANSMISSION RAIL → TRADE-ACCOUNT BOUNDARY → WTO NON-DISCRIMINATION MAP → TARIFF SPACE LADDER → FTA STATUS AND ORIGIN → CREATION VERSUS DIVERSION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 →

STAGE 00 TRADE TRANSMISSION RAIL

TRADE TRANSMISSION RAIL · BORDER RULE · LANDED PRICE + MARKET ACCESS · SOURCING + INVESTMENT · OUTPUT + JOBS + CONSUMERS · MUST REMEMBER · TRADE POLICY COMBINES TARIFFS, NON-TARIFF MEASURES, SERVICES, RULES OF

BORDER RULE → LANDED PRICE + MARKET ACCESS → SOURCING + INVESTMENT → OUTPUT + JOBS + CONSUMERS → MUST REMEMBER: Trade policy combines tariffs, non-tariff measures, services, rules of

CORE CLAIM
- BORDER RULE
- LANDED PRICE + MARKET ACCESS

MECHANISM
- SOURCING + INVESTMENT
- OUTPUT + JOBS + CONSUMERS

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Trade policy combines tariffs, non-tariff measures, services, rules of...
- BORDER RULE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Trade policy combines tariffs, non-tariff measures, services, rules of.

01 →

STAGE 01 TRADE-ACCOUNT BOUNDARY

TRADE-ACCOUNT BOUNDARY · GOODS CROSSING BORDERS · MODE-SPECIFIC SUPPLY · TOTAL TRADE · STATE INCLUDED COMPONENTS · CURRENT ACCOUNT · BROADER THAN TRADE BALANCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders	TOTAL TRADE → state included components	MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders
SERVICES → mode-specific supply	CURRENT ACCOUNT → broader than trade balance	SERVICES → mode-specific supply

CORE CLAIM
- MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders
- SERVICES → mode-specific supply

MECHANISM
- TOTAL TRADE → state included components
- CURRENT ACCOUNT → broader than trade balance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders
- SERVICES → mode-specific supply

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TOTAL TRADE → state included components; CURRENT ACCOUNT → broader than trade balance.

02 →

STAGE 02 WTO NON-DISCRIMINATION MAP

WTO NON-DISCRIMINATION MAP · TREATMENT ACROSS TRADING PARTNERS · NATIONAL TREATMENT · INTERNAL TREATMENT AFTER ENTRY · AGREEMENT-SPECIFIC CONDITIONS · CUSTOMS DUTY · BORDER STAGE

MFN → treatment across trading partners

NATIONAL TREATMENT → internal treatment after entry → EXCEPTIONS → agreement-specific conditions → CUSTOMS DUTY → border stage

CORE CLAIM
- MFN → treatment across trading partners
- NATIONAL TREATMENT → internal treatment after entry

MECHANISM
- EXCEPTIONS → agreement-specific conditions
- CUSTOMS DUTY → border stage

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MFN → treatment across trading partners
- NATIONAL TREATMENT → internal treatment after entry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXCEPTIONS → agreement-specific conditions; CUSTOMS DUTY → border stage.

03 →

STAGE 03 TARIFF SPACE LADDER

TARIFF SPACE LADDER · BOUND RATE · NEGOTIATED CEILING · APPLIED RATE · RATE ACTUALLY CHARGED · GAP BETWEEN THE TWO · PRESERVE SCHEDULE + DATE

BOUND RATE → negotiated ceiling

APPLIED RATE → rate actually charged → WATER → gap between the two → CHANGE → preserve schedule + date

CORE CLAIM
- BOUND RATE → negotiated ceiling
- APPLIED RATE → rate actually charged

MECHANISM
- WATER → gap between the two
- CHANGE → preserve schedule + date

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BOUND RATE → negotiated ceiling
- APPLIED RATE → rate actually charged

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WATER → gap between the two; CHANGE → preserve schedule + date.

04 →

STAGE 04 FTA STATUS AND ORIGIN CHAIN

FTA STATUS AND ORIGIN CHAIN · ENTERED INTO FORCE · PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN · RULES OF ORIGIN · PREFERENCE ELIGIBILITY

NEGOTIATING → SIGNED → RATIFIED → ENTERED INTO FORCE → PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN → RULES OF ORIGIN → preference eligibility

CORE CLAIM
- NEGOTIATING → SIGNED → RATIFIED
- ENTERED INTO FORCE

MECHANISM
- PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN
- RULES OF ORIGIN → preference eligibility

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NEGOTIATING → SIGNED → RATIFIED
- ENTERED INTO FORCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN; RULES OF ORIGIN → preference eligibility.

05 →

STAGE 05 CREATION VERSUS DIVERSION

CREATION VERSUS DIVERSION · TRADE CREATION · LOWER-COST PARTNER REPLACES DOMESTIC SUPPLY · TRADE DIVERSION · PREFERRED PARTNER DISPLACES CHEAPER OUTSIDER · WELFARE + PRODUCTIVITY · DO NOT INFER FROM GROSS TRADE ALONE · CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply	TEST → welfare + productivity	CLOSE DISTINCTION: FTA signature is not entry into force or utilisation, tariff binding...
TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider	DO NOT infer from gross trade alone	TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply

CORE CLAIM
- TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply
- TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider

MECHANISM
- TEST → welfare + productivity
- DO NOT infer from gross trade alone

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: FTA signature is not entry into force or utilisation, tariff binding...
- TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: FTA signature is not entry into force or utilisation, tariff binding.

06 →

STAGE 06 TRADE-REMEDY DECISION TREE

TRADE-REMEDY DECISION TREE · DUMPING + INJURY · ANTI-DUMPING ROUTE · SUBSIDY + INJURY · COUNTERVAILING ROUTE · IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY · DGTR FINDING · NOT FINAL DUTY

DUMPING + INJURY → anti-dumping route

SUBSIDY + INJURY → countervailing route → IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY → safeguard → DGTR FINDING → not final duty

CORE CLAIM
- DUMPING + INJURY → anti-dumping route
- SUBSIDY + INJURY → countervailing route

MECHANISM
- IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY → safeguard
- DGTR FINDING → not final duty

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DUMPING + INJURY → anti-dumping route
- SUBSIDY + INJURY → countervailing route

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY → safeguard; DGTR FINDING → not final duty.

07 →

STAGE 07 TRIMS AND TRIPS BOUNDARY

TRIMS AND TRIPS BOUNDARY · GOODS-LINKED INVESTMENT MEASURES · MINIMUM IP STANDARDS · SERVICES RULES · DOMESTIC LAW · GRANT + ENFORCEMENT

TRIMS → goods-linked investment measures

TRIPS → minimum IP standards → GATS → services rules → DOMESTIC LAW → grant + enforcement

CORE CLAIM
- TRIMS → goods-linked investment measures
- TRIPS → minimum IP standards

MECHANISM
- GATS → services rules
- DOMESTIC LAW → grant + enforcement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TRIMS → goods-linked investment measures
- TRIPS → minimum IP standards

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GATS → services rules; DOMESTIC LAW → grant + enforcement.

08 →

STAGE 08 IGC OBJECTIVE TRAP

IGC OBJECTIVE TRAP · INTERGOVERNMENTAL GRAIN-TRADE BODY · MARKET INFORMATION + COOPERATION · NOT UN RELIEF AGENCY · NOT FCI PROCUREMENT OR PRICE SETTING

CORE CLAIM
- INTERGOVERNMENTAL GRAIN-TRADE BODY
- MARKET INFORMATION + COOPERATION

MECHANISM
- NOT UN RELIEF AGENCY
- NOT FCI PROCUREMENT OR PRICE SETTING

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- INTERGOVERNMENTAL GRAIN-TRADE BODY
- MARKET INFORMATION + COOPERATION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NOT UN RELIEF AGENCY; NOT FCI PROCUREMENT OR PRICE SETTING.

09 →

STAGE 09 PROTECTION COST CASCADE

PROTECTION COST CASCADE · UPSTREAM TARIFF · INPUT COST · DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE · COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT

UPSTREAM TARIFF → INPUT COST → DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE → COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT

CORE CLAIM
- UPSTREAM TARIFF
- INPUT COST

MECHANISM
- DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE
- COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- UPSTREAM TARIFF
- INPUT COST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INPUT COST; DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE; COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT.

10 →

STAGE 10 WTO DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT STATUS

WTO DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT STATUS · PANELS CONTINUE · APPELLATE BODY · NO NEW APPEALS SINCE DEC 2019 · NOTIFIED APPEALS ACCUMULATE · WEAKENED SYSTEM · NO SYSTEM

PANELS CONTINUE

APPELLATE BODY → no new appeals since Dec 2019 → NOTIFIED APPEALS ACCUMULATE → WEAKENED SYSTEM != NO SYSTEM

CORE CLAIM
- PANELS CONTINUE
- APPELLATE BODY → no new appeals since Dec 2019

MECHANISM
- NOTIFIED APPEALS ACCUMULATE
- WEAKENED SYSTEM != NO SYSTEM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PANELS CONTINUE
- APPELLATE BODY → no new appeals since Dec 2019

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: APPELLATE BODY → no new appeals since Dec 2019.

11 →

STAGE 11 TRADE-POLICY ANSWER SPINE

TRADE-POLICY ANSWER SPINE · DEFINE LEGAL CATEGORY + STATUS · TRACE VALUE-CHAIN INCIDENCE · TEST CONSUMERS + FIRMS + WORKERS · CONCLUDE CAPABILITY + DIVERSIFICATION · EVIDENCE LIMIT · SPECIFY AGREEMENT PARTIES, PRODUCT/SERVICE

DEFINE legal category + status → TRACE value-chain incidence → TEST consumers + firms + workers → CONCLUDE capability + diversification → EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Specify agreement parties, product/service

CORE CLAIM
- DEFINE legal category + status
- TRACE value-chain incidence

MECHANISM
- TEST consumers + firms + workers
- CONCLUDE capability + diversification

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Specify agreement parties, product/service...
- DEFINE legal category + status

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Specify agreement parties, product/service.

E →

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · COMPARATIVE ADVANTAGE EXPLAINS GAINS FROM TRADE, WHILE STRATEGIC TRADE · EFFECTIVE PROTECTION CAN EXCEED THE NOMINAL TARIFF WHEN OUTPUT · GVC PARTICIPATION DEPENDS ON PREDICTABLE CUSTOMS, LOGISTICS, STANDARDS, IMPORTED · TRADE REMEDIES REQUIRE EVIDENCE OF INJURY AND CAUSAL LINKAGE · DIGITAL TRADE ADDS DATA, LOCALISATION, SOURCE-CODE, TAXATION AND PLATFORM-REGULATION · RESILIENCE POLICY SHOULD DIVERSIFY SUPPLIERS AND BUILD CAPABILITY RATHER · PROVIDES MULTILATERAL TRADE RULES, NEGOTIATION FORUMS AND DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Comparative advantage explains gains from trade, while strategic trade arguments focus
- CAUTION: Effective protection can exceed the nominal tariff when output protection combines with
- CAUTION: GVC participation depends on predictable customs, logistics, standards, imported inputs
- CAUTION: Trade remedies require evidence of injury and causal linkage under applicable rules.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: Digital trade adds data, localisation, source-code, taxation and platform-regulation
- CAUTION: Resilience policy should diversify suppliers and build capability rather than pursue
- WTO: provides multilateral trade rules, negotiation forums and dispute-settlement
- Department of Commerce: negotiates trade agreements and administers trade- policy

LEGACY / NUANCE
- DGTR: investigates specified trade-remedy cases under applicable law.
- Customs and standards or testing bodies: implement border treatment, origin
- CAUTION: A high tariff on an imported component can protect one upstream producer while making
- CAUTION: Rules of origin prevent goods from a non-member merely passing through an FTA partner

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels